



Government College Women University Sialkot

INTERNSHIP REPORT ON

MEEZAN BANK LIMITED

Internship Report submitted to the Department of Business Administration in Partial
Internship Report Fulfillment of the Requirements for the Degree of Bachelor of
Business Administration.

By

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Date of Submission: 8th June, 2026

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

In the name of Allah Almighty, the Most Beneficent and Merciful, I am truly grateful for His countless blessings, guidance, and strength, which enabled me to complete this internship successfully. I also express my deep love and respect for the Holy Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H), whose teachings serve as a role model for all of mankind.

I would like to extend my heartfelt gratitude to my loving parents and siblings for their continuous support, prayers, and encouragement throughout my educational journey. Their motivation has always been a source of strength for me.

I am especially grateful to our chairperson Dr. Yasin Munier, Our Coordinator Ma'am Hafsa Zafar, and to all my respected teachers for their continuous guidance, support, and assistance throughout my educational and internship journey. Their encouragement and help made this experience more meaningful and productive.

I would also like to express my sincere thanks to Ms. Sundas Sohail (Branch Service Officer, BSO) at Meezan Bank for her valuable support, guidance, and sharing of practical knowledge during my internship. I am also thankful to all the senior staff members of Meezan Bank who cooperated with me and guided me professionally across different departments

- Mr. Bilal Mushtaq Awan (Branch Manager)
- Mr. Muzammil Khadim (Operations Manager)
- Mr. Shahzaib Ali (Branch Service Officer)
- Mr. Mubashir Ahmed Janjua (Trade Finance Officer)
- Ms. Dilawaiz (Personal Banking Manager)
- Ms. Tehreem (Personal Banking Officer)

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A mandatory component of the BBA course offered by the Government College for Women University, Sialkot, is an internship. The main aim of this program is to provide students with practical exposure to the theoretical knowledge that will assist them in establishing professional careers in the future. I did my internship at Meezan Bank Limited under the Youth Islamic Banking Program (Y-IBP) of the State Bank of Pakistan.

The report contains all the details about my one-month internship at Meezan Bank Limited, Kashmir Road Branch, between 16th June and 15th July 2025. I researched the banking environment and the working culture of the top Islamic bank in Pakistan. I was able to see the functioning of the banking system in the real world, acquire the documentation processes, and train in customer service under the guidance of professional staff.

One of the most important things in this internship was getting to know the concept of Islamic banking and observing its workings at Meezan Bank. Some of the products and services that I got to learn about include Meezan Accounts, Takaful, Car and Bike Ijarah, Easy Home Program, Meezan Internet and WhatsApp Banking, Mobile App, and Utility Bill payment. As an intern at Meezan Bank, my main objective was to gain hands-on experience of core banking functions and understand how banks operate to support the economy and serve customers.

During my internship, I gained knowledge of banking operations, staff training, hiring and firing procedures, auditing, marketing, and the importance of maintaining good working conditions in the banking sector. I was allowed to work in different departments, such as Cash, Sales, Operations, and Trade during my internship, which helped me connect my theoretical knowledge with real-world practices. This internship enhanced my knowledge of the practical application of theoretical knowledge and provided a profound insight into all the banking operations.

All in all, this was a good experience in an internship. It provided me with a profound insight into Islamic banking, as well as the general picture of the culture, systems, and values of Meezan Bank. It was efficient and inspiring, and I think it will be beneficial in my future career.

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Part-I

2 INTRODUCTION

Meezan Bank has been on the frontline in shaping the Islamic banking in Pakistan. From its beginnings as an investment bank to its present-day status as the largest and best-known Islamic commercial bank in the country, Meezan Bank has continuously grown in the services it provides and the number of customers it serves, without compromising Shariah-compliant finance. The bank has remained in launching innovative Islamic financial products and increasing customer trust. Its constant expansion is an indication of its adherence to the promotion of interest-free banking in the country.

2.1 Vision

Establish Islamic banking as the banking of first choice to facilitate the implementation of an equitable economic system, providing a strong foundation for establishing a fair and just society for mankind.

2.2 Mission

To be a premier Islamic bank, offering a one-stop shop for innovative value-added products and services to our customers within the bounds of Shariah, while optimizing the stakeholders' value through an organizational culture based on learning, fairness, respect for individual enterprise, and performance.

2.3 Objectives

To develop a committed service culture which ensures the consistent delivery of our products and services within the highest quality service parameters, promoting Islamic values, and ensuring recognition and a quality banking experience to our customers

2.4 Core Values

- Shariah-compliance
- Integrity
- Service Excellence.

3 OVERVIEW OF THE ORGANIZATION

3.1 Brief History of Meezan Bank

Meezan Bank Limited was incorporated in Pakistan on **January 27, 1997**, as a public limited company under the Companies Act, 2017 (previously Companies Ordinance, 1984). As AL-Meezan Investment Bank was established to follow the Islamic principle regarding banking, for this, Riba (interest) free certificates were introduced. The Bank was granted a Scheduled Islamic Commercial Bank license on **January 31, 2002**. It was converted into a full-fledged commercial Islamic bank and formally commenced operations as a Scheduled Islamic Commercial Bank, and it was renamed as Meezan Bank. effective **March 20, 2002**. Furthermore, the 1st Riba-Free Car Financing (Car Ijarah) was launched in Pakistan.

In 2003, as a pioneer of Islamic banking, it launched its branches in all of the major cities of the country. A wide range of Islamic products were developed, such as Meezan Islamic funds (Mutual Funds), and a Shariah-compliant home financing scheme (easy home) was introduced. In 2004, it acted as Shariah structuring advisor for the international Sukuk offering. ATMs and Debit cards were introduced. In 2005, it became 1st customer of Islamic insurance (Takaful), which brought a new era in Islamic banking. In 2006, internet banking was introduced. In 2007, the bank launched Istisna financing to aid with Working capital needs. In 2009, it launched Meezan Labbaik, A Hajj and Umrah Product to facilitate Muslims, and Meezan Visa Debit Cards were introduced.

In 2010, a wide range of products was introduced to help businesses. In 2012, the Bank started Premium banking services to facilitate Premium consumers. In 2014, the mobile banking app was introduced. In 2016, Corporate websites were launched. In 2022, Meezan Senior Citizen Accounts were launched. In 2023, it launched Meezan Women's 1st Debit Card. In 2024, Launched the world's 1st Financial Inclusion Card.

Currently, the Bank is engaged in corporate, commercial, consumer, investment, and retail banking activities. The bank has developed an extraordinary research and development capability by combining investment bankers, commercial bankers, Shariah scholars, and legal experts to develop innovative, viable, and competitive value propositions that not only meet the requirements of today's complex financial world but do so with world-class service excellence, which our customers demand, all within the bounds of Shariah. By

implementing robust & aggressive strategic and tactical initiatives in consumer banking, Meezan Bank aims to fulfill its primary target of providing customers with accessibility and convenience within an atmosphere and culture of dedicated service and recognition of their needs.

3.2 Nature of the Organization

Meezan Bank, an Islamic commercial bank, operates according to the principles of Islamic finance and economics. Conventional banks follow an interest-based (Riba) system, but Meezan Bank follows Islamic principles and conducts all of its activities and operations according to Shariah, guaranteeing that all the products and services offered are free from Riba and aligned with Islamic values.

As a public limited company, Meezan Bank is listed on the Pakistan Stock Exchange (PSX) and is governed by the State Bank of Pakistan (SBP). With Islamic modes of finance, the bank provides a variety of banking services. Its purpose is to offer competitive financial facilities and advance Islamic finance.

Meezan Bank also focuses on building strong relationships with its customers by ensuring trust, transparency, and fairness in all services. The bank provides a wide range of products such as deposits, investments, trade finance, and consumer banking, all designed in line with Shariah rules. It promotes financial inclusion by offering services for both individuals and businesses, helping them manage their finances in a Halal way. In addition, the bank takes part in social and community development activities, reflecting its commitment not only to financial growth but also to social responsibility. By combining modern banking practices with Islamic values, Meezan Bank has established itself as a leading and reliable Islamic bank in Pakistan.

3.3 Brand Personality

Meezan Bank's brand personality is balanced, professional, and trustworthy. It combines strength with empathy and builds customer relationships through honesty and reliability. The Bank is committed to Shariah principles and offers complete, value-based financial solutions. Its character reflects professionalism, care, and responsibility, making it a reliable choice for customers and organizations.

3.4 Shareholding Structure

Shareholders	Percentage
Noor Financial Investment Company	35.15%
Pakistan Kuwait Investment Company (Pvt.) Ltd	29.19%
Islamic Development Bank	25.65%
Others	9.29%

3.4.1 Noor Financial Investment Company (Kuwait)

A Kuwaiti investment firm and the financing arm of the National Industries Group, offering services in private equity, investment strategy, M&A advisory, risk management, and asset management across Kuwait, the Middle East, and Asia.

3.4.2 Pakistan Kuwait Investment Company (Pvt.) Ltd (PKIC)

A joint venture between the Governments of Pakistan and Kuwait, established in 1979, engaged in investment and development banking. It is one of Pakistan's most profitable institutions with a top AAA credit rating.

3.4.3 Islamic Development Bank (IsDB)

An international financial institution based in Jeddah, founded in 1974 to promote economic and social development in 57 member Islamic countries through equity participation, loans, and financial assistance.

3.5 Business Volume

It is not only the numbers that can demonstrate the expansion of Meezan, which started as the smallest bank in 2002 to become one of the largest banks in Pakistan by 2025. It is all about leading people in the direction of the ideals of Islamic banking and making what seemed impossible, impressive achievements. Branch after branch, Meezan has expanded over time, and today it offers its diverse assortment of Shariah-compliant products and services to people in the country. At the moment, Meezan Bank boasts 1,051 branches and 1,219 ATMs in 351 cities. In addition, it has created 12 Consumer Financing Centers to offer financing support to the citizens. It has 15 exclusive Premium Banking Centers for its high-end customers. This is a large and well-organized network that demonstrates the

dedication of the bank to accessibility, convenience for the customers, and inclusive finance. The fast pace of development of Meezan is an indication of the operational excellence it has developed over the years, as well as the loyalty and trust that the company has gained among millions of customers in the country.

Location	Branches	ATMs
Punjab	511	559
Sindh	296	390
Khyber Pakhtunkhwa	87	93
Balochistan	40	34
Islamabad	98	125
Azad Jammu & Kashmir	14	12
Gilgit-Baltistan	5	6

3.6 Rewards and Recognition

Meezan Bank has been widely credited with a remarkable leadership role in the banking industry by both national and international bodies, a distinction the bank has proudly earned over the last three decades through its exceptional performance and unwavering commitment to Shariah-compliant excellence. Its consistent dedication to innovation, transparency, and ethical banking has positioned it as a benchmark for Islamic finance in Pakistan.

- Pakistan Banking Awards – Best Bank of Pakistan (2023 & 2024).
- 12th Annual Fire Safety Awards – Fire Safety Award (2022).
- CFA Society Pakistan – Best Bank of the Year – Large Size Banks (2022, 2023 & 2024).
- CFA Society Pakistan – Islamic Bank of the Year (2023 & 2024).
- The Banker – Bank of the Year Awards – Bank of the Year, Pakistan (2024)
- Asian Banking & Finance – Retail Banking Awards – Digital Business Banking Initiative of the Year – Pakistan (2024)
- Pakistan Stock Exchange – Top 25 Companies of the Year 2023

- Employers Federation of Pakistan (EFP) – Employer of the Year – Gold Award (Large National Companies) (2024)
- Global Islamic Finance Awards (GIFA) – Best Islamic Bank & Shariah Auditor of the Year (2024)
- Islamic Finance News, Malaysia – Best Islamic Bank in Pakistan & Best Islamic Retail Bank (2024)
- Global Finance – World’s Best Islamic Financial Institutions – Best Islamic Financial Institution in Pakistan (2022 & 2024)
- ICAP & CA Pakistan Digital Technology Awards – Best Dashboard Prepared (First Prize – 2024)
- Pakistan Banking Awards – Best Consumer Bank (2022)
- The Banker – Islamic Bank of the Year, Pakistan (2022)
- Islamic Finance Forum of South Asia (IFFSA) Awards – Gold Award for Islamic Finance Entity of the Year (2022)
- Global Islamic Finance Awards (GIFA) – Most Outstanding Leader in Islamic Finance (2022)
- Asset Triple A – Hong Kong – Best Islamic Investment Bank – Pakistan (2022)

3.7 Product & Services Lines

Meezan Bank, being Pakistan's first and largest commercial Islamic bank, offers a diverse range of Shariah-compliant products and services to cater to individuals, businesses, commercial entities, and corporate consumers. All offerings provided by the bank are fully aligned with Islamic regulations and are approved by the Shariah Administrative Board.

Through its strict adherence to Islamic principles, innovative financial solutions, and customer-focused approach, Meezan Bank has established itself as a trusted leader in interest-free banking. Its commitment to ethical practices and transparency further strengthens its reputation as the most reliable and respected Islamic financial institution in the country.

- Deposit Products
- Meezan Rupee
- Meezan Asaan

- Meezan Express
- Meezan Kids Club
- Meezan Teen Club
- Meezan Asaan Student
- Meezan Senior Citizen
- Meezan Women First
- Meezan Labbaik
- Meezan Kafalah
- Meezan Bachat
- Meezan Plus
- Karobari Munafa
- Foreign Currency
- Meezan Roshan Digital
- Meezan Roshan Resident
- Meezan Payroll Partner
- Account Opening Facility for
- Freelancers
- Meezan Digital Asaan
- Meezan Digital Remittance
- Meezan Digital Freelancer
- Islamic Naya Pakistan Certificate
- Monthly Mudarabah Certificate
- Certificate of Islamic Investment
- Certificate of Islamic Investment Senior
- Meezan Aamdan Certificate
- Meezan Aamdan Certificate for Senior
- Citizens, Widows & Disabled Persons
- Dollar Mudarabah Certificates.

3.7.1 Types of Accounts

Local Currency Accounts

- Rupee Current Account - a secure and convenient account for deposits.
- Rupee Saving Account – guaranteeing a truly halal savings account with complete returns.
- Meezan Bachat Account- a convenience savings account offering halal profit.
- Labbaik Saving Asaan Account - a specialized saving account designed for umrah & hajj.
- Business Plus Account- serving you the perfect blend of convenience and flexibility.
- Meezan Kids Club Account - a specialized savings account for kids under the age of 12 years.
- Meezan Teen Account - Mudarabah-based savings account specifically for teens.
- Meezan Assan Current Account – a safe and stable deposit account.
- Meezan Assan Saving Account – a comprehensive return that ensures halal savings.

Foreign Currency Account

- Dollar Current Account
- Dollar Saving Account
- Euro Current Account
- Euro Saving Account
- Pound Current Account
- Pound Saving Account

3.7.2 Branchless Banking

- Smart Remittance Wallet
- Smart Asaan Mobile Account
- Smart Disbursement Solution
- Smart Wallet

3.7.3 Priority Banking

- Meezan Premium Banking

3.7.4 Consumer Banking

- Car Ijarah
- Roshan Apni Car
- Meezan Women First
- Meezan Apni Bike
- Easy Home
- Meezan Roshan Apna Ghar
- Meezan Consumer Ease
- Meezan Solar
- Meezan Labbaik
- Meezan FCY Debit Card
- Meezan Mastercard Debit Cards
- Meezan Visa Debit Cards
- Meezan PayPak Debit Card
- Meezan Supplementary Debit Cards
- Contactless Payments
- Discounts & Privileges
- Fintech Services
- Meezan POS Terminals
- Meezan E-Commerce Payment Gateway

3.7.5 Transaction & Employee Banking

- Meezan eBiz+
- Meezan eBiz+ LITE
- Meezan Payroll Partner

3.7.6 Financing Product

- Murabaha | Short-Term Facility
- Musawamah | Short-Term Facility
- Istisna | Short-Term Facility
- Commodity Salam | Short-term Facility products
- Tijarah | Short-Term Facility
- Ijarah | Long-Term Rental Facility
- Running Musharakah
- Diminishing Musharakah
- Structured Finance Solutions
- Letter of Credit Services
- Short-Term Import Financing
- Long-Term Import Financing
- Shariah-compliant Hedging
- Alternative to Export Bill Discounting
- Islamic Export Refinance Scheme
- Islamic Long-Term Finance Facility
- Retail Supply Chain Financing
- Digital Supply Chain Financing
- Commercial Vehicles Financing

3.7.7 Alternative Distribution Channel

- Meezan Digital Account Opening App
- Meezan Mobile Banking App
- Meezan Internet Banking
- Meezan WhatsApp Banking
- SMS Alerts
- Meezan ATM Network

So, Meezan Banking is divided into two parts

Personal Banking	Bank Account
	Term Deposits
	Consumer Finance
	Home Remittance
	Premium Banking
Business Banking	Small Business
	Corporate Banking
	Islamic Advisory Services
	Agricultural Finance
	Correspondent Banking
	Asset Management

3.8 PEST Analysis

The first and largest Islamic commercial bank in Pakistan, Meezan Bank Limited, is involved in the dynamic macro-environment, which is affected by the political, economic, social, and technological factors. These are the main opportunities and threats of each of these dimensions as outlined in the following analysis.

3.8.1 Political Factors

Opportunities: Meezan Bank became the first bank in Pakistan to be granted an Islamic commercial banking license, and hence it has established itself as a leader in the Islamic finance industry. The policies of the government and the stable assistance of the State Bank of Pakistan (SBP) to the development of Islamic banking provide the bank with a good chance to develop. The focus of the government on expanding the Islamic finance industry and a gradual transition to a more inclusive financial system also strengthens the competitiveness of Meezan Bank.

Threats: Despite this, there are significant challenges in the political environment of Pakistan. The political instability has persistently affected the general business environment. At the same time, regular changes in the policies of the government, taxation,

and banking regulations have a direct impact on the activities of MBL, its long-term planning, and adherence to regulations.

3.8.2 Economic Factors

Opportunities: The Pakistani economy is growing, and with increasing financial literacy, more and more people are demanding banking services. This convergence provides great potential for Meezan Bank to expand its customer base. The economic growth and the increasing acceptance of Islamic banking products allow the bank to provide diversified financial solutions. As Islamic finance continues to be promoted, Meezan Bank can use its leadership in the market to take a bigger portion of the domestic banking market and even spread to other regions.

Threats: Nonetheless, the existing economic situation in Pakistan poses great threats. The consumer purchasing power and financing demand have been eroded by high inflation, depreciation of the currency, and variable interest rates. The poor economic performance of the country, growing fiscal deficit, and increasing levels of foreign debt have led to a challenging business environment, which impacts the profitability of the bank.

3.8.3 Social Factors

Opportunities: Socially, the increasing awareness and acceptance of the Islamic banking principles, both locally and globally, an opportunity for Meezan Bank. Being the biggest Islamic bank in Pakistan, MBL has an opportunity to utilize its Shariah-compliant status to win the attention of more customers who are interested in ethical and interest-free financial services. The growth of religiously oriented banking by the general population is a good opportunity that MBL can utilize in order to increase its coverage by educating the people, including them in financial services, and engaging them in community development initiatives.

Threats: There are, however, socio-cultural elements that hinder the growth of the bank. Poor knowledge of the concepts of Islamic banking among certain sections of the population limits its use. Furthermore, the conventional way of thinking and customer resistance to digital and modern banking practices, including ATMs and online transactions, influence the efficiency of operations. These social and cultural limitations require sustained awareness campaigns and education programs to help boost customer trust and increase the adoption of Islamic banking practices.

3.8.4 Technological Factors

Opportunities: Technological advancement allows Meezan Bank to innovate and enhance service delivery. Embracement of digital banking, mobile banking, and automation software has contributed to the increased convenience of customers and operational efficiency. The emphasis of MBL on the incorporation of modern computer systems keeps employees updated and able to provide high-quality services. Online banking, email communication, and a wide network of ATM have also allowed the bank to improve its relationship with its customers using technology.

Threats: The key thing is that the dynamic nature of technology requires constant investment in new systems and educating staff. The inability to stay up to date with the latest technologies might result in operational inefficiencies, threats to cybersecurity, and possible loss of market share to more technologically advanced competitors. Therefore, managing the challenges of digital transformation remains an ongoing concern for Meezan Bank, which requires long-term innovation and investment.

Conclusion

To conclude, the external environment surrounding Meezan Bank is complex with both opportunities and threats. Although favorable government policy, economic potential, growing social acceptance of Islamic finance, and technological opportunities offer growth opportunities, political instability, economic volatility, low levels of public awareness, and technological pressures are also major challenges. Meezan Bank should be able to strategically balance these factors through innovation, effective governance, and active policy adjustment to maintain its leadership in the Islamic banking industry.

3.9 Contribution Toward Economic Development

Meezan Bank has helped in the economic development of Pakistan through ethical banking by encouraging Riba-free banking. It has contributed to the growth of involvement in the economy by providing a diverse selection of Islamic financial products that have made people trust the financial system more. The bank favors the following sectors as SMEs, corporates, commercial business, agriculture, and housing. It assists industries in developing and generating employment, and encourages the economy at large through financial aid.

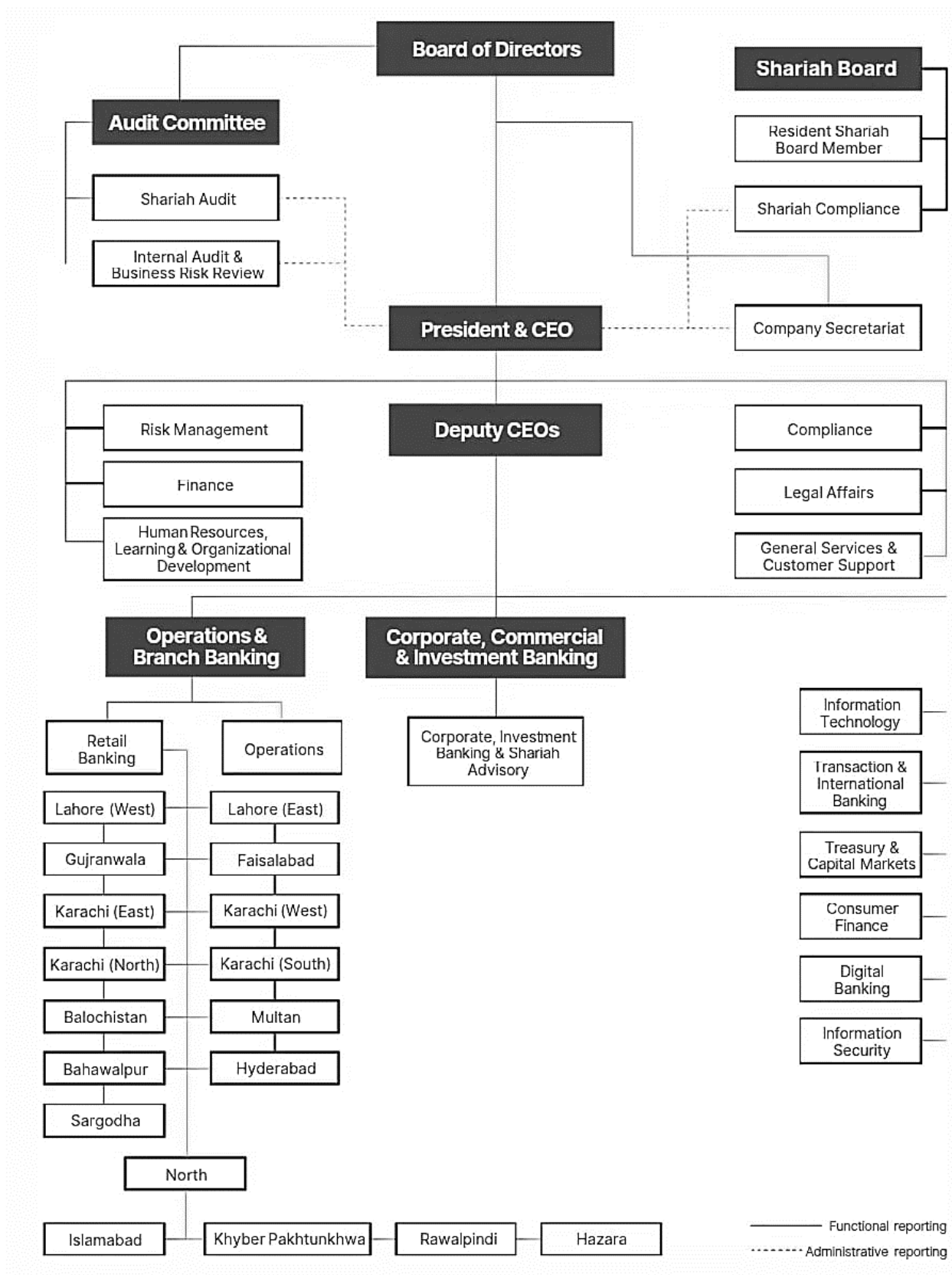
To ordinary people, Meezan provides easy, convenient, and easy-to-use services such as Asaan Accounts, savings and current accounts, mobile and internet banking,

WhatsApp banking, and home, car, and mobile financing. These services assist people in dealing with money and improve their lifestyle.

Meezan is an active participant in the communities as a responsible corporate entity and leaves a significant social impact. It also contributes to charitable funds, donations, scholarships, and sponsorship in Corporate Philanthropy, Financial Education, awareness, Skill development, healthcare, education, environmental sustainability, and economic development are some of its contributions that are part of its Corporate Social Responsibility.

- Donations of solar panels to the Indus Hospital to reduce the electricity cost.
- Donation of medical equipment to the Government Hospital, Nowshera, is a significant contribution to the medical infrastructure.
- To support kidney failure patients, Meezan donated Rs 700,000 to Alamigir Welfare Trust International for the purchase of a Renatron Machine.
- To raise awareness of Hepatitis, Meezan collaborated with the health foundation in 2024 by supporting the Golf Tournament.
- To promote financial awareness among the female population, Meezan conducted a 3-week women's financial inclusion campaign across Pakistan.
- Signed an MOU with 19 leading universities for Islamic Finance capacity building.
- Introduced the Meezan ship Program to provide internship opportunities to last semester students and fresh graduates.
- Conducted a Job Fair and an education expo in 2024 to support minorities.

4 ORGANIZATION STRUCTURE



4.1 Head Office – Meezan Bank

Address

📍 Meezan House, C-25 Estate Avenue, SITE, Karachi, Pakistan

Email

✉ info@meezanbank.com

✉ complaints@meezanbank.com

Contact Numbers

☎ PABX: (92-21) 38103500

☎ UAN: 111-331-331 / 111-331-332

Website

🌐 <https://www.meezanbank.com/>

4.2 Employee Details

According to the Annual Report 2024, Meezan Bank's employee statistics for the year 2024 are as follows:

Category	Number
Total Employees	17000+
Total Staff Inducted	3,385
Batch Hiring	1,533
Promotions	1,184

Diversity Highlights

Category	Number
Female Employees Inducted	795
Differently-abled Individuals Inducted	38

Additional Details

- 146 Employees' Children Supported through Meezan Scholar Policy
- 10 Employees & Dependents Sponsored for Hajj
- 660+ Families Supported via Employee Benevolent Fund Trust (EBFT).

4.3 Introduction to All Departments

4.3.1 Corporate Banking

The main purpose of this department is to support the corporate clients' needs and demands, such as working capital finance and trade finance. They provide financial services to larger enterprises.

4.3.2 Consumer Finance

They provide financial facilities to the general public and normal customers. The products and services are Riba-free, through which customers can buy or build a new house or can renovate the existing house, and it also provides leasing facilities for cars, bikes, etc.

4.3.3 Operations and Branch Banking

Their role is to look after the day-to-day banking operations across the country. They play a key role in maintaining coordination among all the branches to ensure that all transactions proceed smoothly.

4.3.4 Digital Banking

This department oversees the activities of all digital platforms of the banks, including mobile, internet banking, and WhatsApp banking.

4.3.5 Risk Management

This department is supposed to detect any financial risk that the bank might be exposed to and offer as many solutions as possible in case it gets into any trouble. They also ensure that the bank adheres to the risk policies.

4.3.6 Treasury and Home Remittances

Management of liquidity, investment, and Foreign exchange falls under their supervision. Meezan Bank also provides remittance services to its customers.

4.3.7 Information Technology

The IT support center of Meezan Bank is working day and night to improve its technologies by bringing advancement in them so it can provide a safe and secure banking system to its stakeholders.

4.3.8 Compliance

The task of this department is to ensure that the bank adheres to the regulatory policies that are decided by the State Bank of Pakistan, as well as the internal policies of the bank. They also make sure that the bank is operating within the Shariah principles

4.3.9 Audit and Business Risk Review

To find the areas for improvement and to inspect the working efficiency of all the departments, the bank frequently conducts internal and external audits and reviews of the branches.

4.3.10 Legal Affairs

Their work is to provide the bank with legal advice so that all the banking operations follow the law. They also prepare all the legal documents and resolve disputes.

4.3.11 Human Resource and Development

This department does the recruitment, training, and career development of staff. They also take care of their employees' rights and build discipline in the organization by creating a positive working culture.

4.3.12 Service and customer support

Customer Support Center of Meezan Bank is working on the front line with customers who face any complaint, inquiry, or request. The staff always try their best to provide satisfactory solutions and guidance to all the clients so that a positive relationship can be created between the bank and the customers.

Part-II

5 Internee Work

5.1 Branch Introduction

I worked as an intern at Meezan Bank, located on Kashmir Road, Sialkot. This is the main branch of the Sialkot Region. This branch has four departments, each of which plays a significant role in carrying out its tasks. These are the Cash Department, the Operations Department, the Sales Department, and the Trade Department. Opening of bank accounts, cash deposits, cash withdrawals, clearing of cheques, payment of utility bills, transfers of funds, and assisting customers are all the major day-to-day activities that are being handled from the branch end.

As a main branch of the Sialkot region, it also serves as the Trade Hub, so there is a fully functional Trade Department that handles trade-related dealings. Furthermore, to provide financing to SME, corporates, commercials, and the agricultural sector, the Credit Department is also operating from this branch. The back-end offices, such as the Regional and Area Offices, are also a part of the branch building. However, these departments and offices have no direct involvement in the branch's day-to-day activities but they still support the branches in managing and approving various banking activities.

5.2 Duration of Internship

- **Starting Date of Internship:** 16th June, 2025.
- **Ending Date of Internship:** 15th July, 2025.

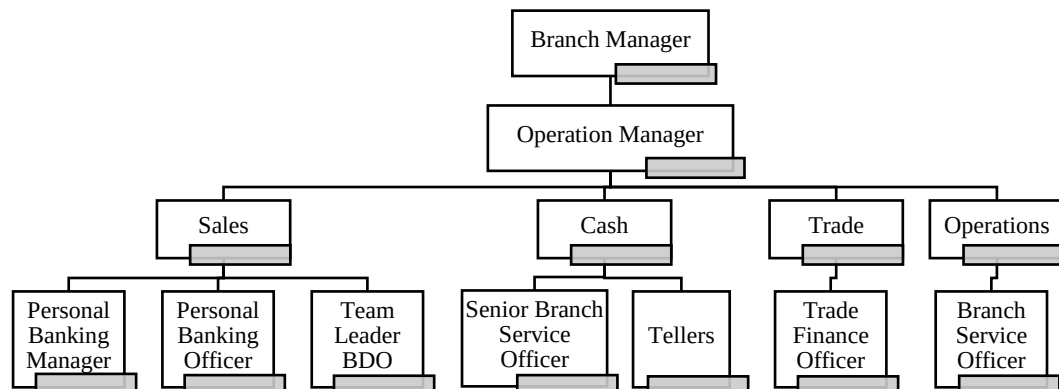
5.3 Supervisor Details

My supervisors during the internship:

- Ms. Sundus Suhail, Branch Service Officer | Operations Department, Meezan Bank Kashmir Branch.
- Mr. Shahzaib Ali, Branch Service Officer | Operations Department, Meezan Bank Kashmir Branch.
- Mr. Mubashir Ahmed Janjua, Trade Finance Officer | Trade Department, Meezan Bank Kashmir Branch.

- Ms. Dilawaiz, Personal Banking Manager | Sales Department, Meezan Bank Kashmir Branch.
- Ms. Tehreem, Personal Banking Officer | Sales Department, Meezan Bank Kashmir Branch.

5.4 Branch Hierarchy



5.5 Branch Timings

- **9:00 am- 6:00 pm** | Monday to Thursday
- **9:00 am-1:00 pm**, (Jummah Break), **2:30 pm-6:00 pm** | Friday
- **9:00 am – 2:00 pm** | Saturday

5.6 My Area of Internship

As my intern, I was primarily assigned to two core departments, Operations and Sales. During my experience in these departments, I gained a wide range of practical experience in the banking processes and dealing with customers. During the internship, I was able to do the assigned tasks as well as observe and learn different operational and financial processes.

- Operations
- Sales
- Cash
- Trade

5.7 Introduction of Branch Departments

5.7.1 Operation Department

The Operations Department is the support system for banking functions. The main activities of this unit are account maintenance, clearing, fund transfers, and record-keeping of the customer. This unit helps the bank stay in compliance with regulations, general standards, and both internal and external policies. It assists cash, trade, and sales departments through its exceptional service.

5.7.2 Sales Department

The vital unit of every bank is its Sales Department. In Meezan Bank, the Sales Department supports the growth of the bank through the sales of Shariah-compliant products and services to the public. Its main focus is to attract new customers by helping walk-in customers, completing all the paperwork needed for account opening, and providing direction to customers on the Islamic financial solutions offered by the bank. Their goal is to develop strong and good customer relationships to achieve sales targets and to keep them well-informed about all the offerings of the bank.

5.7.3 Cash Department

Due to the security protocol of the bank, only SBSO, Tellers, Operations Manager, and Branch Manager are allowed to have access to the cash vault; therefore, I was unable to enter the vault. However, the complete description of the working and operations of the cash department was provided to me. This department was responsible for dealing with all cash-related transactions, which include cash deposits, cash withdrawals, cash balancing, and utility bill payments.

5.7.4 Trade Department

The Trade Department of a bank monitors all international trade transactions on behalf of its clients. This department is working to promote import and export by ensuring that all trade-related processes operate smoothly. One of the major functions of this unit is issuing and administering Letters of Credit (LCs). They also ensure that all operations comply with the national and international trade laws.

6 Departmental Work Plan

Week 1	Branch overview & Operations Department
Week 2	Operations & Sales Department
Week 3	Operations & Cash Department
Week 4	Operations & Trade Department
Week 5	Overview & Reporting

6.1 Weekly Timetable

6.1.1 Week 1

Date	Work Accomplished
16 June, 2025	Introduction to Meezan Bank, branch environment, organizational structure, departments, and workplace ethics
17 June, 2025	Learned about deposit slips, their purpose, customer handling, and form-filling procedures.
18 June, 2025	Learned about cheques, cheque processing, crossing of cheques, and verification procedures.
19 June, 2025	Studied the clearing process, the cheque clearing system, and the role of NIFT
20 June, 2025	Learned management of 500K files and customer record handling procedures.

My first day at Meezan Bank was an orientation session during which I was introduced to the bank's environment, structure, and work ethic. In the Operations Department, I learned about cheque and deposit slip filing, the clearing system, and basic branch operations.

6.1.2 Week 2

Date	Work Accomplished
23 June, 2025	Assisted in ATM card handling, customer calls, card delivery, and deposit slip guidance.
24 June, 2025	Learned about pay orders, their purpose, issuance process, and documentation.
25 June, 2025	Learned types of accounts, account opening procedures, and required documentation.
26 June, 2025	Learned about Takaful/insurance products and their role in Islamic banking.
27 June, 2025	Studied Kafaalah, mutual funds, Wakala, and Sukuk concepts and operations.

During the second week at Meezan Bank, I learned about the pay order process and explored the sales department. I also gained knowledge about different account types, Islamic banking products, Takaful, Sukuk, and other financial services offered by the bank.

6.1.3 Week 3

Date	Work Accomplished
30 June, 2025	Learned about callback confirmation (CBC), its purpose, and customer verification procedures.
2 July, 2025	Learned the due diligence process, the importance of compliance, and the different due diligence types.
3 July, 2025	Observed cash operations, cash handling procedures, and different types of cash transactions.
4 July, 2025	Learned cash counter transactions, balancing procedures, and cash management activities.

During the third week at Meezan Bank, I gained further understanding of the Operations and Cash departments. I learned about cash handling procedures, State Bank cash management policies, and important concepts about cash handling.

6.1.4 Week 4

Date	Work Accomplished
7 July, 2025	Learned about RTGS (Real-Time Gross Settlement) and interbank fund transfer systems.
8 July, 2025	Learned about amendments, dormant account activation, and related banking procedures.
9 July, 2025	Introduction to trade operations and how banks facilitate trade activities.
10 July, 2025	Learned about the Pakistan Single Window and different modes of trade.
11 July, 2025	Learned about the SWIFT system and ITRS (International Transaction Reporting System).

During the fourth week at Meezan Bank, I continued assisting in the Operations Department and learned about RTGS, IBFT, Raast, remittances, and amendments. I was also introduced to the Trade and Credit Departments, where I gained basic knowledge about import/export documentation and banking credit operations.

6.1.5 Week 5

Date	Work Accomplished
14 July, 2025	Learned about Islamic financing procedures for SME and corporate clients
15 July, 2025	Final review of internship learning, reporting work, branch overview, and summary of departmental observations.

My internship at Meezan Bank concluded on 15th July; the final week consisted of mainly of observational learning. During this period, I learned about ATM card operations, observed departmental coordination, and reflected on my overall internship experience.

6.2 Detailed Description of The Weekly Projects Assigned

6.2.1 1st Week (16th June, 2025 to 21st June 2025)

In my first week, I was given the task of overseeing the issuance of ATM cards. This involved accepting ATM cards at the Sales Department, opening and verifying them, marking and sorting them systematically, and ensuring that they are well filed. I also had to make calls to customers to inform them about the arrival of their ATM cards, to deliver the cards to them during their visits, to get their signature in order to be acknowledged, and to make sure that all records were properly kept to be easily tracked and secured.

I was actively involved in helping the customers fill out their cheques and deposit slips correctly. I also handled clearing instruments and took part in securing and segregating them, making sure they were well arranged. This practical experience helped me to learn more about the working processes of cheque clearing and the bank clearing system.

6.2.2 2nd Week (23rd June, 2025 to 28th June 2025)

Another thing I learned during my internship in Meezan Bank is the maintenance of the 500K File, where all of the daily transactions, both debit (withdrawals) and credit (deposits), less than 500 lakhs are recorded. This file is updated on a daily basis, and every page is sorted out by listing all the debit transactions first and then the credit transactions. Each debit transaction was to be written against the code IKJL according to the internal procedure of the bank, and each credit transaction against the code ABCDE.

After the transactions had been duly registered, I was required to stamp the pages and have them signed by the Branch Manager and place them in the record file under the appropriate date. This contributed to the maintenance of proper documentation, transparency, and adherence to bank policies.

During the second week of my placement at Meezan Bank, I was involved in processing ATM cards, calling customers, and keeping up with the 500K file by recording and stamping credit and debit transactions. I assisted the customers in the filing of deposit slips and cheques, and the clearing and segregation of cheques. At the Sales Department, I arranged account opening documents and stamped the necessary forms for various types of accounts

6.2.3 3rd Week (30th June, 2025 to 5th July 2025)

Besides learning several concepts of banking, my key duties throughout the week were many practical activities, which included attending to ATM cards, which involved receiving, marking, filing and calling their customers to pick up the cards; attending to the 500K file and arranging it date-wise to be easily tracked; stamping and ensuring that their paperwork was signed by the Operations Manager and the Branch Manager; filling deposit slips and cheques on behalf of the customers and assisting and guiding them whenever they had any questions. These duties gave me an opportunity to gain a more insightful idea of how branches work and enhance my customer service.

6.2.4 4th Week (7th July, 2025 to 12th July 2025)

In the fourth week, I was doing the main tasks that I was assigned at the start of the internship. These were the processing of ATM cards, making phone calls to collect cards, filling deposit slips and cheques, and updating the 500K file. Stamping documents, filing, and organizing important paperwork were also my responsibilities. These activities, based on productivity, allowed me to gain consistency, attention to detail, and a greater insight into routine operational procedures within the banking setting.

6.3 Detailed Description of the Departmental Activities of Meezan Bank

6.3.1 Deposit Slip

To deposit money into bank accounts, either in cash, by cheque, or by pay order, customers must fill out a paper form called a deposit slip.

Purpose of Deposit Slip

The deposit slip is used to:

- Keep record of the amount deposited with the purpose of the transaction.
- Provide acknowledgement to both the customer and the bank.
- Assist the bank in monitoring transactions to maintain accuracy in banking operations.

I learnt how to fill out deposit slips and assist the customers in filling out their slips as well.

6.3.2 Cheque

A cheque is a written and negotiable instrument that allows the account holder (the drawer) to tell the bank to pay or transfer a specific sum of money (written in words as well as digits) from their bank account to the person whose name is written on it or to the person who holds it (the payee).

Real vs. Fake Cheques:

We also learnt how to identify real and fake cheques.

- A real cheque has the cheque number written twice, and the account number written thrice to prove its legitimacy.
- Most of the time, counterfeit cheques have incorrect or missing information, broken font, or are poorly printed, or the figures are irregular.
- The bank staff passes the cheque through a UV machine to verify its authenticity if they are not satisfied.

Crossing on a Cheque

When two parallel lines are drawn on the upper left corner of the cheque, that is called the crossing. This feature is added for security purposes because crossing means the amount cannot be paid in cash; instead, it will be deposited into the bank account, reducing the risk of fraudulent activities.

1. Normal Crossing: If two simple parallel lines are drawn on the cheque, it is called normal crossing. The amount will be deposited into the bank account of the person whose name is written on it or into the account of the bearer.
2. Special Crossing: When two parallel lines are drawn with the name of a specific bank or person written in between, such as Account payable only, the money can only be deposited into that person's bank account.

6.3.3 Clearing Process

An advanced and developed system through which the payments of the cheques and the pay orders are settled (cleared) between various banks using a central system.

Classification of Clearing

1. Inward Clearing: It is defined as the receiving of the cheques and pay orders that belong to the bank (i.e., Meezan Bank) and are forwarded by other banks.

2. Outward Clearing: It refers to the cheques and pay orders received by the bank (i.e., Meezan Bank) from its own customers, but they are issued by other banks.

Types of Clearing

1. Normal Clearing: This is the most common type of cheque settlement in a banking institution. All cheques that are deposited before 03:30 PM (in Meezan Bank) are delivered for settlement, and the funds are cleared and settled on the next working day. Normal clearing is usually preferred by customers who make regular transactions, because it incurs no extra charges.
2. Same-Day: Same-day clearing means the settlement of a cheque on the same day it is deposited. So, a customer who wants to avail this service must deposit the cheque in the bank before 10:00 AM (in Meezan Bank). This type of clearing offers faster settlement of payment, and there are charges attached to this service. (e.g., Rs. 500 in Meezan Bank).
3. Intercity Clearing: A cheque that is deposited in one city and issued by a separate branch in a different city is said to be intercity cleared. Such clearing usually takes more than one working day to proceed because of geographical distance and involvement of multiple branch sites (e.g., 48-74 hrs.).

6.3.4 Meezan Bank and the NIFT Clearing System

Meezan Bank has now implemented a centralized clearing system. So, under this system, all the inward clearings of one region are settled at its main branch, while outward clearing is handled by each branch individually to enhance processing speed, accuracy, and efficiency. Like all other banks, Meezan Bank also uses NIFT (National Institutional Facilitation Technologies), which is responsible for collecting, processing, and transmitting both physical and electronic financial instruments, mostly cheques and pay orders, among banking institutions, as a reliable channel for all of its clearing operations.

6.3.5 Reasons for Cheque Bouncing

A cheque is bounced or dishonored if:

- There is an inadequate balance in the account.
- The cheque has an alteration in date/name/signature/mutilated, it requires the drawer's full signature.
- The account is closed/dormant/blocked/deceased.

- The amount in words and figures differs.
- Payment was stopped by the drawer.
- The cheque is outdated/post-dated/stale.
- There is a mismatch of the signature or any suspicious activity

6.3.6 Pay Orders

Pay Orders (POs) are secure and guaranteed documents that are used in payment transactions. The bank issues a pay order on behalf of its customers to pay a specific amount to a specific person or organization. It is non-transferable and cannot be endorsed or bounced, as the required funds are already debited from the account of the customer before it is issued.

The clearing of the pay orders follows the normal cheque clearing procedure, that is, outward clearing and inward clearing

6.3.7 Accounts & Documentations

In the Sales Department, I was able to learn a lot about the process of opening an account, the documentation required, and the types of products and categories available in Meezan. The bank mainly offers two categories of accounts: Current Accounts and Savings Accounts. These two categories have a variety of products to aid customers of different segments.

- **Asaan Account**

The Asaan Account is one of the simplest and most universal types of accounts that is offered to those who do not have a regular income source. It is easy and accessible since it can be opened in both current and savings categories, and only a valid CNIC is required.

- **Individual Account**

The Individual Account is further sub-classified into salaried individuals, self-employed individuals, or individuals with financial support. A salaried individual needs documentation, like a salary slip (containing name, CNIC, designation, and salary). A visit report, company letterhead, and evidence of running a business are required for a self-employed individual. In case an individual has financial support from a family member or relative, a record of the source of income and verification of the relationship is needed.

- **Proprietor Account**

An account of the proprietor is opened under a sole proprietorship, where a visit report, Form 181, National Tax Number (NTN), and a colored letterhead with company stamp and signature must be provided.

- **Partnership Account**

In a partnership account, the key documents would be a Partnership Deed, Form C (when it was first registered), Form D (in case of changes), NTN, a visit report, and a colored letterhead with company stamp and signatures of all partners.

- **Private Limited Company Account**

The process of opening a Private Limited Company Account is more complex. The documents that are necessary include Form A, Form 29, the Memorandum of Association, and the Memorandum of Articles that outline the rules of the company, structure, and customer details. Other documentation, like NTN, colored letterhead, and visit reports, is needed too. The documents are first submitted to the Head Office for screening, and only after their approval is the account opened.

- **Photo Accounts**

Photo accounts are opened on behalf of those who are unable to sign or face difficulty in signing, such as the old, illiterate, or disabled. A passport-sized photograph is placed on the account opening form to identify the customer, and in place of a signature, the thumb impression of the individual is taken. In some cases, they are indicated as Unable to Draw Signature (UDO) to ensure it is properly verified.

- **Other Accounts**

Meezan Bank also facilitates account openings for NGOs, charitable organizations, and non-profit entities. The Shariah Department gives the approval for these accounts, which is to make sure that these accounts are in line with Islamic principles. Their records are more complicated and consist of registration certificates, details of the governing body, NTN, authorization letters, and visit reports.

In all forms of accounts, the following are mandatory:

- Compliance
- Verification of all individuals through biometric or Veresis

- KFS (Key Fact Statement) form, which outlines information about profit rates, service charges, and other important information of the accounts to enhance transparency and awareness for the customer.
- In case of Savings Account, a Zakat Declaration Form.

6.3.8 Islamic Banking and Financing at Meezan Bank (Overview)

In the sales course, I got to know that Islamic banking is different from conventional banking as it strictly prohibits the concept of Riba (interest) and has a concept of profit and loss sharing. All products and services at Meezan Bank are Shariah-compliant based on the values of Shariah Compliance, Integrity, and Service Excellence. Every new product is considered and approved by a dedicated Shariah Board prior to launch.

Meezan Bank provides a number of modes of Islamic finance such as:

- Mudarabah: A person brings capital; the other manages the business; profits are shared, but the losses are borne by the investor.
- Musharakah: Both invest and share profits and losses.
- Murabaha: The bank buys an asset and then sells it to the customer at a known profit.
- Murabaha and Musawamah – Both are similar, with the difference that cost and profit margin are not known.
- Salam: Pre-payment for goods, things to be delivered later.
- Istisna: Financing for a manufacturing or construction project.
- Ijara: Rental of assets for a fixed rental amount.

Meezan Bank offers a variety of Shariah-compliant financial products and services that include savings accounts and financing products to serve its customers' financial needs.

6.3.9 Islamic Alternative to Insurance – Takaful

In Islamic finance, conventional insurance is not permissible due to the presence of gharar (uncertainty) and qimar (gambling). Instead, Meezan Bank offers Takaful, an Islamic insurance system based on Ta'awun (cooperation) and Tabarru (voluntary contribution). Under Takaful, participants contribute to a common fund to support one another in case of loss, promoting mutual assistance rather than risk transfer for profit.

6.3.10 Kafalah

Kafalah is a Shariah-compliant long-term savings plan offered by Meezan Bank under the Takaful framework. Unlike conventional savings accounts, Kafalah does not involve interest; instead, profits are variable and depend on returns from Shariah-compliant investments. The plan helps customers save for goals such as education, marriage, retirement, and Hajj while fully complying with Islamic principles.

6.3.11 Mutual Funds

Meezan Bank's Shariah-compliant Mutual Funds are designed for customers who require regular income and liquidity. Profits are paid monthly and can be withdrawn as needed. A small service fee is charged, and returns vary according to market performance. All investments follow Islamic guidelines and offer transparency through publicly available performance records.

Additionally, Meezan Bank offers a range of Shariah-compliant savings accounts tailored for different customer segments, including:

- Women First Account
- Senior Citizen Account
- Minor Account
- Teenage Account
- Kids Club Account

Each of these accounts is designed to meet the specific needs of its target audience while ensuring compliance with Islamic banking principles.

6.3.12 Wakalah

Wakalah is an Islamic finance contract based on agency, where one party (Rabb-ul-Maal) appoints another party (Wakeel/Agent) to perform a task on their behalf. It is a trust-based agreement in which ownership and risk remain with the principal, while the agent acts in the best interest of the principal and may receive a fixed fee or a share of profit as compensation.

6.3.13 Sukuk

Since conventional bonds involve riba (interest), Islamic finance offers Sukuk as a Shariah-compliant alternative. Sukuk represent ownership in an underlying asset or project,

and investors earn returns from the actual profits generated rather than fixed interest. At Meezan Bank, Sukuk are mainly offered to corporate clients and high-net-worth individuals, ensuring asset-backed and Shariah-compliant investments.

6.3.14 Call Back Confirmation

Call Back Confirmation is an internal control used to prevent cheque-related fraud. At Meezan Bank, CBC is performed by contacting the cheque issuer to verify the authenticity of the transaction. It is required for cash cheques exceeding Rs. 500,000 and transfer cheques of Rs. 1,000,000 or more. CBC is also conducted for cheques received through inward clearing, helping to ensure secure and authorized transactions.

6.3.15 Due Diligence Procedures

During my internship, I learned about Customer Due Diligence (CDD), Enhanced Due Diligence (EDD), and Simplified Due Diligence (SDD), which are part of KYC and AML regulations.

- CDD applies to most account holders and involves identity verification and risk assessment.
- EDD is used for high-risk customers and requires stricter monitoring.
- SDD is applied in low-risk cases with simplified verification requirements.

6.3.16 Cash and Its Types

The most widely accepted medium of exchange in a tangible form is cash, which may be in the form of currency notes and coins. It is the most liquid asset amongst individuals and organizations. Cash in banking terminology is considered the most liquid type of money, allowing instant settlements, withdrawals, deposits, and over-the-counter transactions without incurring delays in clearance or processing. During my internship, I was taught about different types of cash and their proper handling procedures.

- Fresh Cash: This consists of fresh notes that have been issued directly by the State Bank.
- Reissue Cash: The cash taken from the customers is processed, then any unfit or dirty notes are separated, and the rest of the fit money is issued for further use.

- **Unsorted Cash:** This consists of cash that has not been sorted or counted using a machine. It must be sorted before use.
- **Soiled Cash:** This comprises damaged, torn, or overused notes. These are the notes gathered by customers, but they cannot be returned to the customer. These should be submitted to the State Bank or to the bank where the bank has an account.
- **PIN Cash:** It is machine-processed, packed, and sealed cash. In case PIN Cash or Unsorted Cash is issued to a customer, the bank can be fined Rs. 100,000 by SBP.
- **Consolidated Cash:** This refers to the total closing cash balance held by the branch at the end of the day, including cash in hand and in transit.
- **Unconsolidated Cash:** It is cash of one branch or unit, which is not included in other accounts. It is cash at hand and bank accounts.
- **Clean Note Policy:** This is a policy of the State Bank of Pakistan that promotes the circulation of clean, untorn, and readable notes. Banks are to issue fresh or fit cash to their customers.
- **Claim Notes:** Damaged Notes (burnt, cut, torn, or seized) that can be claimed, provided there is at least 75% of the note left. Notes that have been damaged on purpose cannot be claimed, whereas damaged notes that occur accidentally can be claimed.
- **Wash or Suspicious Notes:** These are Notes whose color, print, or ink looks faded or suspicious. The State Bank verifies such notes, and they cannot be recirculated.
- **Commemorative Currency and Coins:** Special notes and coins are special coins and notes issued by the State Bank to commemorate national events, anniversaries, or milestones. They are legal tenders, but they are not used in daily transactions.

6.3.17 Cash Counter Transactions and Balancing System

At Meezan Bank, cash counter operations include deposits, withdrawals, and bill or fee payments. At the end of each day, every teller must balance physical cash with the system-recorded balance. Any cash shortage or excess must be reported immediately with a valid reason. A branch can hold a maximum of Rs. 100 million, including ATM cash.

Tellers are allowed to keep only 40% of the cash vault amount at their counters, while the remaining cash must stay in the vault.

6.3.18 Real-Time Gross Settlement

RTGS (Real-Time Gross Settlement): This is a quick and safe method of transferring high-value payments between banks. These transactions are cleared immediately and on an individual basis, typically within 15-25 minutes, and each bank has predefined working hours (e.g., Meezan Bank until 3:30 PM). It reduces risks in handling cash and also makes the interbank transactions fast and reliable.

6.3.19 Interbank Fund Transfer (IBFT) system

IBFT (Interbank Fund Transfer): This is a 24/7 electronic fund transfer system applicable for the payment of low to medium value between two or more banks. It offers immediate credit and is usually applied in the routine transfers via mobile or internet banking and ATMs.

6.3.20 Amendments

When any adjustment is made to the details of an existing bank account, it is referred to as an amendment.

Types of Amendments

- Alteration in the title of account (e.g., due to marriage, legal update, change of business name).
- Modification of contact information (phone number, email, address).
- Account type change (e.g., individual to joint or business to personal).
- Alteration in signatory (particularly in partnership or company accounts).
- CIF (Customer Information Form) Refreshing.
- Any change in instructions to operate or those authorized to operate in a business account.

6.3.21 Dormant Accounts Activations.

An account that has not recorded any debit or credit within a period of 12 months or more is called a dormant account.

Reactivation Process

The customer must visit the bank in person. The form for account activation is filled out, or a written request is submitted with the required documents. After due process, the bank identifies and re-enables the account.

6.3.22 Remittance

I also got to know the concept of remittance in the Operations Department, which is defined as the transfer of money from one person or entity to another, typically across national borders. There are two types of them.

- **Home Remittance:** Personal transfers made by individuals (mainly from outside the country) to their family members within Pakistan. Only home remittance is processed at Meezan Bank because they use known relationships and have better verification in case of any future issues.
- **Business Remittance:** Is used for a commercial reason, such as payment between businesses. This type is not processed at the branch level in Meezan.

To receive home remittance, customers must complete biometric verification to confirm their identity. Remittances from services like RIA and Western Union are also handled, so biometric verification, as well as compliance, is mandatory for Western Union payments.

6.3.23 CIF – Customer Information Form

CIF is an abbreviation of Customer Information Form. It has all the personal and business information of the account holder.

Purpose: It is applied to gather and store up-to-date and correct information about customers.

Updating of CIF:

- The CIF must be updated with any change in the customer information (e.g., name, contact number, address, email, CNIC details, etc.).
- The customer signs the updated CIF, and the bank staff verifies.

6.3.24 Trade and PSW-Bank Association

I was able to experience in the Trade Department how the bank intermediates and controls importation and exportation activities. The State Bank of Pakistan regulates all trade-related transactions in Pakistan. Pakistan Single Window (PSW) is the web-based trade portal that has been set up to computerize and centralize the importation and exportation activities in Pakistan. With the help of this system, trading activities are controlled. It creates a single platform by consolidating the importers/exporters, banks, customers, and other regulatory agencies.

- Every importer/exporter must obtain registration at the PSW portal.
- Upon registration, the traders have to connect their PSW profile to a bank where he/she can activate the trade transactions.

6.3.25 Modes of Trade

There are four major trade finance modes used in a Trade Department that I was introduced to. They are advance payment, open account, documentary collection, and Letter of Credit. These modes specify the payment system and the amount of risk that is taken by the importer and exporter. The most popular and safe way out of these is the Documentary Credit (Letter of Credit). LC is a written commitment issued by the bank of the importer that the exporter will be paid in case the terms and conditions of the LC are fulfilled.

6.3.26 Documentary Credit – Letter of Credit (LC)

It is the most widely used and the safest trade finance paper, particularly for international trades that have not been done with parties that are not familiar.

An LC is a written guarantee from the importer's bank to pay the exporter if the exporter meets the terms and conditions that are listed in the LC.

Before issuing an LC, the bank will evaluate the importer's credibility and transaction performance. The importer will be given a limit corresponding to their financial status.

The bank takes the risk and makes the payment to the exporter, and gives trust and security to the trade deal.

How LC Works

- The importer asks their bank to give an LC in favor of the exporter.
- The bank reviews the importer's financials prior to issuing the LC.

- The exporter sends in the necessary shipping documentation (invoice, bill of lading, etc) to their bank on shipment.
- The bank makes the payment within five working days upon the documents being determined as compliant.
- The importer receives the documents and clears the goods from customs.

6.3.27 SWIFT

The Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Telecommunication (SWIFT) is an international system that enables banks to transmit financial messages and instructions securely and promptly. It is also used mainly in trade to send Letters of Credit, instructions to pay or receive payment in the import and export of goods, and shipping information, and to submit a confirmation of transfers of funds between banks across jurisdictions. Such a system improves the security, speed, and reliability of global trade.

6.3.28 ITRS

The International Transaction Reporting System (ITRS) is a system used by banks to disclose any trade-related as well as foreign exchange transactions to the State Bank of Pakistan. It is a system that captures import and export payments and makes sure that all the foreign transactions fall within the SBP guidelines, and therefore, ensures transparency and control in the foreign trade operations.

6.3.29 Overview of the Credit Department

Although the Credit Department does not directly handle routine branch operations, since my internship was at the Main Branch, I had the opportunity to gain a brief understanding of its functions.

Core Focus Areas

The Credit Department primarily deals with:

- SMEs (Small and Medium Enterprises)
- Corporate clients
- Commercial businesses
- Agricultural sector.

Shariah Rules of Sale and Purchase

I was also introduced to the six key rules of Islamic sale and purchase, which must be followed under Shariah:

- The asset or product must exist at the time of sale.
- The seller must have ownership of the asset.
- The asset must be in the possession of the seller before selling.
- The product should be halal (permissible) under Islamic law.
- The value of the asset must be properly determined.
- The asset must be clearly identified and not ambiguous.

7 Summary of Learning

I had worked closely in two key units, i.e., Operations and Sales. These assignments gave me practical exposure to the majority of the banking processes and services for customers. This time also entailed not only the completion of some part of the internship by completing some of the tasks, but I also got to observe and learn how the processes of the functioning and finances work.

7.1.1 Skills and Qualifications acquired.

This practice in Meezan Bank enabled me to enhance my soft skills as well as have a good command of the Islamic Banking principles. This is unlike other banks, and Meezan works within the Shariah-compliant models, and I was told how to differentiate such products as Murabaha, Istisna, and Ijarah. This demanded sharp and detailed observation since any process and document had to be aligned with the ethical and legal requirements. I also managed to get to know about banking and digital literacy. My working experience in a high-flow branch presupposed that I needed to prioritize tasks. I also had to juggle between serving walk-in customers and administration, especially during the rush hours. Lastly, the exposure to sensitive financial information also helped me to be more conscious of my work ethic and to train myself to be calm and functional under pressure. I was also informed that the most important aspect of the banking industry is trust and that honesty and professionalism are something that I should not compromise. I have never lost this lesson, and I have kept it in my mind up to date as a guide on how I will go about my work and responsibilities.

7.1.2 Responsibilities Undertaken

Handling ATM cards and cheque books meant that I was likely to market rather than be exposed to marketing, as I had learned the value of security. I have also realized that identity checks are something that should be taken seriously since sensitive financial instruments should not be in unscrupulous hands. When I called for confirmation and worked with some files with the value of 500K as an over-precaution, I noted that just one mistake in the operation of adding the records would cause enormous operational risks. I learned that banking is highly sensitive to compliance with the regulations when performing the process of document checking and stamping. Another experience that I had was the cross-checking of account opening forms with government documentation and bank policies, and as such, I learned the importance of data integrity. I also observed that a well-structured system of filing is as significant as the services offered to the customers in filling their deposit slips and account forms and making them feel like a financial consultant of the community. Rather than just issuing the forms, I would explain to the customers some of the complex terms of banking in simple terms, as most of them were too baffled. This helped me to know how to meet their customer needs, how to streamline the operations in such a way that they can enhance their customer experiences as well as be accurate even during the moments when the pressure was on. The transaction record preparation of the 500K debit/credit files gave me insight of how banks prepare to pass internal audit. I was informed that the stamp and signature are audit trails and are responsible and transparent. This taught me a lesson in professional responsibility and that I shall always exercise care when handling even the tiniest aspect of an assignment, as I am now committed to it as part of my responsibility as a professional; a sense that I have now come to realize was part of my responsibility as a finance career in the future, in whatever I do, regardless of how small.

7.1.3 Future career plans will be influenced.

The internship has played a major role in my career projections and plans. It also made me specific and confident to love banking as a well-organized and promising profession. The real-life exposure helped me to gain knowledge on how banking is done in the real-world setting, and that is why I seriously thought of banking as my career choice. The banking experience also assisted me in discovering the skills and competencies required to become the best in the segments of operations and customer services. I also started to think about

banking as a good occupation and a profession that offers a chance to become a professional and develop skills. The idea of Islamic banking was one of the best things I could have learned during my course of experience. Other products like Murabaha, Istisna, and Ijarah that have been introduced by Meezan Bank's Shariah-compliant models have also exposed me to more information about Islamic finance. This experience has not only made me think more about learning this discipline in the future, but the types of work I could do in this profession have also taught me transferable skills that can be used in any job. These include communication skills, teamwork, and time management. Not only are they skills that are confined to banking, but they can be used in the area of corporate services and finance, and can also be employed in other areas like corporate travel management. Lastly, the internship also taught me that a degree in banking and finance can provide me with a wide scope of career opportunities, not necessarily only in the banking industry, but in other spheres of business. The internship also made me have a sense of professional responsibility and an effective working ethos. Due to the exposure to a real-life scenario, besides the transferable skills, I am now also confident in my choices that concern career issues. On the whole, this internship experience has opened my eyes; it has made me more interested in Islamic banking, and it has allowed me to have a certain sense of direction for what I want to do with my career.

7.1.4 Correlation with Classroom Knowledge.

My internship was closely related to my studies since much of what I had studied in the classroom was applied in a working banking environment. As an example, I could see and drill such processes as cheques, pay orders, types of accounts, and bank documentation. This provided me with a practical idea about the functioning of these tools, not just theoretically.

The other experience I acquired was in clearing, remittance, accounts handling, and financial transactions. This was what I had learned in theory, and what I was able to observe at work enabled me to bridge the gap between theory and practice. In general, it is the experience during the internship that brought my learning to a new level and demonstrated the importance of practical training in the process of professional development. It not only helps me to relate the education I gained in the classroom to practice, but also helps me to

learn the banking operations, besides providing me with technical and soft skills. The experience has enabled me to become more confident in the career choice that I have made.

8 Conclusion

The internship at Meezan Bank gave me a great opportunity to learn about the day-to-day functioning of the banking industry, including Islamic banking. This experience showed me the workings of Islamic banking based on Shariah-compliant practices, without interest (Riba) and with the principles of risk-sharing and ethically good banking. I also learned about its contrasting features with traditional banking, such as its product offering, processes, and financial structure.

As an intern, I gained the knowledge that the banking industry is well-organized, customer-centric, and technologically advanced. Increasing awareness and trust among customers about ethical finance contributed to the growth of Islamic banking as a steady one. But I also noticed that the industry needs constant innovation, awareness, and financial literacy of customers to further consolidate its position in the market.

This internship experience provided me with the opportunity to make a connection between theory and application in many ways. It helped me develop more knowledge about the functioning of banks and increased my abilities on the job. I am thankful for this learning experience as it will be useful in my future career in finance and banking.

8.1 SWOT Analysis

SWOT Analysis of Meezan Bank Limited

The SWOT analysis is employed to analyze both internal and external strengths and weaknesses of an organization, as well as the opportunities and threats of an organization.

My experience as an intern at Meezan Bank Limited has given me a chance to observe different aspects of operation, technology, and strategy that have transformed the company into what it is today in the context of its performance. The detailed analysis of the organization will be presented in the SWOT analysis below.

8.1.1 Strengths

Meezan Bank Limited has a number of positive qualities that can make it a competitive entity in the Islamic banking and financial technology sphere. The other major strength of the organization is that it is also associated with Meezan Bank, which is among the market leaders in the field of Islamic banking in Pakistan. The association will result in a positive customer base, trust, and credibility.

The other strength is that it has a developed and rated mobile banking application. The internet services that the bank possesses are convenient, safe, and effective enough to enable the customer to make transactions without any problem. It will lead to content customers and financial inclusion via the Internet.

Moreover, the organization is largely perceived to be a good and acceptable institution because the Shariah principles are seriously considered by the organization. The second strength of Meezan Bank Limited is that it has many branches in the country, thereby making it very convenient and easily accessible to customers.

8.1.2 Weaknesses

Despite the limited strengths Meezan Bank Limited has, it has several internal constraints that can influence its performance. The weaknesses comprise customer alternatives and preferences towards diversification, which is inadequate in the sense that the number of Shariah-compliant investment options is low.

The second issue is the lack of specialists in the field of Islamic finance and financial technology. Moreover, the fact that the general population is not aware of the existence of the Islamic banking is present as well, thus limiting market growth.

8.1.3 Opportunities

There are several growth opportunities that Meezan Bank Limited can adopt in the external environment. One of the most promising opportunities is the growing demand for Islamic banking services because the number of people who need Shariah-compliant financial services is growing.

The company can also diversify its services and bring in new innovative financial products according to the requirements of the customers. Through the customer-based solution, the organization will also be capable of enhancing its competitive position.

In addition, one can also invest in talent acquisition/development and strategic alliances with other businesses and organizations. The existing growth and performance are also high, based on the rapid growth of online and mobile banking.

8.1.4 Threats

Meezan Bank Limited is an organization that exists in a dynamic environment, and it is subject to many external threats. Among these significant threats, one may perhaps single out economic recession that may cause the decline of the level of investment activity and the level of financial performance, in general.

The other emerging issue is internet security risks and threats on the internet, as internet users are increasingly using internet banking. Besides that, other market players are also involved in unscrupulous business practices, and changes can make it difficult to fund the sector.

8.2 Financial Ratio Analysis

The financial analysis done in this report is based on the information and data obtained from Meezan Bank during the internship period. It is designed to analyze and underscore the general financial results and soundness of the bank for the previous year.

The study uses financial ratios to interpret the financial statements of the bank in a meaningful and structured way. This will facilitate the analysis of important issues like profitability, liquidity, efficiency, and financial strength of Meezan Bank. The analysis also covers the efficiency of the bank in its utilization of resources and its ability to grow in the Islamic banking industry. Moreover, it gives a clear picture of the performance of the operation of the bank from the available financial data of the year under review. The overall purpose of this section of this report is to link the practical observations and financial performance evaluation together.

8.2.1 Income Statement (2024-2025)

	2025 (PKR)	2024 (PKR)
Profit / Return Earned		
Profit on Islamic financing, investments & placements	420,481,313	494,310,357
Profit on deposits and other dues	(168,026,802)	(207,267,225)
Net Profit / Return	252,454,511	287,043,132
Other Income		
Fee and commission income	29,751,322	25,838,191
Dividend income	379,920	626,540
Foreign exchange income	5,478,364	828,507
Gain on securities	989,329	3,511,916
Net loss on derecognition	-	(186,473)
Other income	1,594,502	1,229,568
Total Other Income	38,193,437	31,848,249
Total Income	290,647,948	318,891,381
Other Expenses		
Operating expenses	(85,405,487)	(81,656,045)
Workers' welfare fund	(4,364,013)	(4,755,777)
Other charges	(80,701)	(435,343)
Total Expenses	(89,850,201)	(86,847,165)
Operating Profit	200,797,747	232,044,216
Share of profit of associates	3,386,722	3,457,443
Profit before provisions	204,184,469	235,501,659
Credit loss allowance	(3,885,731)	(9,222,405)
Profit Before Tax	200,298,738	226,279,254
Taxation	(108,120,276)	(122,559,919)
Profit of the Year	92,178,462	103,719,335

8.2.2 Balance Sheet (2024-2025)

	2025 (PKR)	2024 (PKR)
Assets		
Cash and balances with treasury banks	330,810,281	260,873,367
Balances with other banks	15,439,064	13,290,726
Due from financial institutions	12,325,225	34,964,299
Investments	2,608,334,204	1,878,852,841
Islamic financing and related assets	1,640,934,798	1,514,755,936
Property and equipment	50,826,681	47,226,503
Right-of-use assets	22,174,737	21,622,622
Intangible assets	3,493,490	2,960,432
Deferred tax asset	-	-
Other assets	135,596,974	137,641,875
Total Assets	4,819,935,454	3,912,188,601
Liabilities		
Bills payable	73,767,955	112,605,407
Due to financial institutions	887,048,227	722,286,318
Deposits and other accounts	3,302,337,407	2,584,583,671
Lease liabilities	28,889,130	26,286,276
Subordinated Sukuk	16,990,000	20,990,000
Deferred tax liabilities	3,607,635	15,530,758
Other liabilities	219,097,035	176,275,951
Total Liabilities	4,531,737,389	3,658,558,381
Equity		
Share capital	18,005,546	17,947,407
Reserves	57,984,764	48,026,583
Surplus on revaluation of assets	14,380,110	22,141,192
Unappropriated profit	195,304,919	163,601,395
Total Equity (Shareholders)	285,675,339	251,716,577
Non-controlling interest	2,522,726	1,913,643
Total Equity	288,198,065	253,630,220

8.2.3 Ratio Analysis

- **Current Ratio**

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Current Ratio} &= \text{Current Assets} \div \text{Current Liabilities} \\ &= 4,743,440,546 \div 4,511,139,754 \\ &= \mathbf{1.05: 1}\end{aligned}$$

It indicates that Meezan Bank has slightly more current assets than current liabilities; thus, the bank is in a stable liquidity position. It means that the bank can easily pay off its short-term debts using its short-term assets. It is not very high, but that's satisfactory in the banking sector as banks do not keep a lot of liquid assets; they mostly rely on deposits and financial investments.

- **Cash Ratio**

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Cash Ratio} &= \text{Cash \& Cash Equivalents} \div \text{Current Liabilities} \\ &= 330,810,281 \div 4,511,139,754 \\ &= \mathbf{0.07: 1}\end{aligned}$$

This ratio shows that cash resources immediately cover a smaller portion of liabilities. This indicates that Meezan Bank has slightly more current assets than current liabilities; thus, the bank is in a stable liquidity position. It means that the bank can easily pay off its short-term debts using its short-term assets. It is not very high, but that's satisfactory in the banking sector, as banks do not keep a lot of liquid assets, but they mostly rely on deposits and financial investments.

- **Return on Assets**

$$\begin{aligned}\text{ROA} &= \text{Net Income} \div \text{Total Assets} \times 100 \\ &= 92,178,462 \div 4,819,935,454 \times 100 \\ &= \mathbf{1.91\%}\end{aligned}$$

The ratio is used to measure the efficiency of a bank's assets in producing profits. The ROA of 1.91% suggests that Meezan Bank is making a fair return on its assets, indicating good asset utilization and sound operations. The banking sector is a sector of operations in which even a slight rise in ROA is considered a positive result due to the high value of the assets of banks.

- **Return on Equity**

$$\begin{aligned}\text{ROE} &= \text{Net Income} \div \text{Shareholders' Equity} \times 100 \\ &= 92,178,462 \div 285,675,339 \times 100 \\ &= \mathbf{32.27\%}\end{aligned}$$

ROE ratio is an indication of the profit generated by shareholders' investment in the bank. Meezan Bank's ROE of 32.27% suggests that the bank is efficient at using the funds of the shareholders to make good profits. This also enhances investor trust, and it manifests the bank's robust financial strength and profitability.

- **Net Profit Margin**

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Net Profit Margin} &= \text{Net Profit} \div \text{Total Income} \times 100 \\ &= 92,178,462 \div 290,647,948 \times 100 \\ &= \mathbf{31.71\%}\end{aligned}$$

It is a ratio that shows the percentage of profit realized after taking out all operating expenses, provisions, and taxes from the total income. The high operating profit margin indicates that the bank's operations are running efficiently, with minimal waste and a high profit margin. It is a measure of the strength and continuing good profitability of the overall business of Meezan Bank.

- **Operating Profit Margin**

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Operating Profit Margin} &= \text{Operating Profit} \div \text{Total Income} \times 100 \\ &= 200,797,747 \div 290,647,948 \times 100 \\ &= \mathbf{69.08\%}\end{aligned}$$

The operating margin is high, indicating good management of operating costs and the performance of core banking activities. It reflects efficiency of operation and profitability.

- **Asset Utilization Ratio**

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Asset Utilization Ratio} &= \text{Total Income} \div \text{Total Assets} \\ &= 290,647,948 \div 4,819,935,454 \\ &= \mathbf{0.06}\end{aligned}$$

This indicates the efficiency of the bank in earning money from its assets. The outcome reveals that Meezan Bank is using its resources effectively to earn income from investments

and Islamic banking operations. The banking industry typically has high asset sizes, which leads to a lower asset turnover ratio.

- **Investment-to-Deposit Ratio**

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Investment-to-Deposit Ratio} &= \text{Investments} \div \text{Deposits} \\ &= 2,608,334,204 \div 3,302,337,407 \\ &= \mathbf{79\%}\end{aligned}$$

The ratio shows that a significant portion of deposits has been invested for returns. It is a measure of the efficiency in using the money placed with a bank.

- **Loan-to-Deposit Ratio**

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Loan-to-Deposit Ratio} &= \text{Islamic Financing} \div \text{Deposits} \times 100 \\ &= 1,640,934,798 \div 3,302,337,407 \times 100 \\ &= \mathbf{49.69\%}\end{aligned}$$

This ratio suggests that almost 50% of the deposits are allocated to activities. Represents an integrated financing approach and a risk of liquidity.

- **Debt-to-Equity Ratio**

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Debt-to-Equity Ratio} &= \text{Total Liabilities} \div \text{Shareholders' Equity} \\ &= 4,531,737,389 \div 285,675,339 \\ &= \mathbf{15.86: 1}\end{aligned}$$

This high ratio is typical of the banking sector as deposits form a significant part of financial resources. It means that they are dependent on outside sources to conduct their banking activities.

- **Equity Multiplier**

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Equity Multiplier} &= \text{Total Assets} \div \text{Shareholders' Equity} \\ &= 4,819,935,454 \div 285,675,339 \\ &= \mathbf{16.87}\end{aligned}$$

The size of the equity multiplier is a measure of the financial leverage of the bank. The higher the multiplier, the more the liabilities are used to support the assets, and thus the more shareholder returns are experienced.

9 Recommendation

Based on observations and experiences in Islamic banking during an internship at Meezan Bank, the following recommendations are suggested for further improvement in the promotion of Islamic banking services: Meezan Bank should keep promoting knowledge of Islamic banking principles and products to the masses. While Islamic banking is gaining momentum, there are still a lot of people who do not have full knowledge about how Islamic banking is different from conventional banking. Thus, the bank should conduct more seminars, awareness sessions, and workshops in educational institutions, universities, public areas, etc., to educate students and bank customers about the advantages and workings of Islamic banking. Besides, the bank can further improve its promotion and publicity through mass media, social media, and digital marketing.

Successful promotion and awareness activities can lead to more customers and build trust in the Islamic financial services. The bank should also prioritize enhancing customer service and streamlining its operations by implementing sophisticated technologies and simplifying some of the banking processes. Better service, helpful directions, and streamlined complaint procedures can also improve the satisfaction and loyalty of customers.

Additionally, internship programs should be structured so that students have more hands-on experience. Greater opportunities should be provided to interns to be part of the banking process, customer dealings, and practical assignments so that they will gain insight into the professional working environment. This will not only enhance the students' learning experience, but it will also help enhance their professional and communication skills.

Finally, Meezan Bank should persist in its innovative and expansion efforts in the Islamic banking industry. Establishing new products that are customer-oriented and continuing to operate ethically will help the bank further build its position as a leading Islamic bank in Pakistan.

10 Suggestions for Future Interns

Internships are one of the key components to connect school to work. So, students must take internships seriously, responsibly, and be ready to learn. Interns are encouraged to gain an understanding of the basic banking operations and financial concepts before the internship so that they will be better able to adapt to the working environment. Interns should be engaged in everyday activities rather than just watching. They should learn principles of professional ethics and communication, and gain practical knowledge.

It is also important for interns to get accustomed to banking terms, customer dealings, and working procedures to boost their learning experience. Furthermore, it is essential to be professional in a bank setting. Interns should obey the rules of the workplace, be polite to employees, and refrain from any unnecessary arguments and debates.

Establishing good working relationships with fellow staff and supervisors can foster a healthy learning environment and enhance confidence. Future interns are also encouraged to take initiative and exhibit interest in learning other areas of operations in the department instead of waiting to be given a task. When they encounter problems, they should ask questions relevant to the problem and make efforts to learn from the practical experiences of the employees.

Punctuality, teamwork, discipline, and time management are also important skills students should acquire during the internship period. Lastly, students should consider internships as an opportunity for personal and professional growth. The purpose of the internship should not just be to satisfy the internship requirement, but also to acquire knowledge, experience, and confidence that can benefit them in their future career.

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